Dennis Blake

Software QA Automation Engineer / SDET
Holland, MI • 616-212-5256 • work.dennisblake@gmail.com • linkedin.com/in/dennisjblake
Authorized to work in the US

SUMMARY

QA Automation Engineer with 12+ years of experience building and scaling web, API, and mobile test automation across logistics, fintech, retail, and enterprise platforms. Strong hands-on background with Playwright, Cypress, Selenium/Selenide, Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, REST Assured, Postman, SQL, Docker, and CI/CD pipelines. Experienced in reducing regression time, increasing automation coverage, improving release confidence, mentoring engineers, and partnering with engineering/product teams in Agile environments

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Automation: Playwright, Cypress, Selenium, Selenide, Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, JUnit 5, Mocha, Chai, Cucumber, Gherkin, POM
API / Backend: REST Assured, Postman, Newman, Swagger, REST APIs, SOAP, Fiddler, Burp Suite
CI/CD / DevOps: Git, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Jenkins, CircleCI, Docker, Selenoid, Kubernetes, Allure
Databases: SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, AWS Redshift, data validation, test data management
Testing: Functional, regression, smoke, E2E, sanity, UAT, exploratory, risk-based testing, root cause analysis
Tools: Jira, Confluence, Zephyr, Xray, TestRail, Trello, JQL, JSON, HTML/CSS, XPath, Grafana, Prometheus, Copilot

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software QA Automation Analyst
Mitsubishi Logisnext Americas Inc - Grand Rapids, MI
Apr 2024 - Present

- Built and maintained a Playwright and TypeScript automation framework for web applications with reusable Page Object Model patterns and multi-browser support
- Replaced primarily manual regression testing for 8 applications, reducing regression execution time by 40% and improving release frequency
- Expanded E2E and API automation coverage by 25%, helping reduce production issues and improve release confidence
- Designed CI/CD automation for smoke and regression execution, reducing manual test execution time by 30% and improving early defect detection by 15%
- Improved automation maintainability by applying POM, reusable utilities, retry logic, parallel execution, and flakiness reduction practices, lowering maintenance effort by 30%
- Containerized Playwright execution with Docker and supported reliable automation runs across constrained corporate network environments
- Integrated automation with database layers to retrieve, seed, and clean up test data for stable data-driven test execution
- Mentored non-QA colleagues on Playwright automation to expand team capability and improve coverage ownership

Software QA Automation Engineer
SmarterX LLC - Boulder, CO
Jun 2023 - Feb 2024

- Developed and maintained Cypress and JavaScript automation frameworks, reducing manual testing effort by 35%
- Enhanced API validation using Postman, Swagger, and Newman CLI to improve request/response verification and regression coverage
- Wrote SQL queries for backend data validation, integration checks, and database consistency verification
- Reduced test flakiness by 15% by identifying environment dependencies, improving test stability, and strengthening execution reliability
- Integrated test reporting into dashboards to provide stakeholders with real-time visibility into automation progress and quality risks
- Mentored junior QA engineers and collaborated with product, development, and QA teams to align testing priorities with business requirements

Senior Software QA Engineer
Trinetix LLC - Nashville, TN
May 2016 - May 2023

- Built and maintained Java, Selenium, and BDD automation frameworks for API, functional, smoke, E2E, and sanity testing
- Reduced QA and IT workload by 30% through automation improvements and supported 150+ successful product releases
- Optimized automation suites and test strategy, reducing execution time by 25% and improving regression efficiency
- Created risk-based test plans, traceability coverage, and backend/API validation strategies to improve product quality and release readiness
- Trained new QA team members, improved onboarding efficiency, and supported cross-team testing coordination across multiple environments
- Conducted security-oriented testing and issue investigation, helping identify vulnerabilities and quality risks before release

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Economics